



Joyride on WP8

Microsoft launched the popular game title Jetpack Joyride on Windows Phone 8 devices



iOS 7 announced

Apple announced iOS 7 with the completely redesigned interface and new features
<http://dgit.in/11sc4IK>

GET SMARTER WITH APPS

Agent 001 goes on a mission to uncover the truth behind brain training. Is it truly effective?

Agent 001

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I landed myself a rather cushy task this month which involved spending most of my time in the office with a steaming mug of coffee rather than hunting for a very specific motherboard on Lamington Road in a heavy downpour. It all started when my Digit friends came across this brain training website/app called Lumosity. Lumosity's gamified training program promises a substantial boost in your cognitive and reasoning abilities, in other words it makes you smarter and more intelligent. These claims kicked off a huge debate regarding the efficacy of such brain training programs in actually enhancing your brain's abilities. Now, a lot of research is going on in this particular direction with some of the world's best psychologists and neuroscientists working to find conclusive evidence backed by statistics. But unlike peer reviewed research papers we just took on to test these claims ourselves, we decided to use this service and see for ourselves if it enhanced our brains capabilities. I was to use Lumosity for a month and get a first hand encounter with serious brain training. The next step was determining how would we measure my progress – using Lumosity's own numbers didn't make much sense here. Hence, I decided to settle on a standardized battery of tests created by

the Medical Research Council at Cambridge University. The results would give me my position on a bell curve of the population's performance in the areas of memory, reasoning and verbal ability. I would take the test again after a month and measure my progress and verify the validity of claims discussed earlier.

A little background information on Lumosity before proceeding further: It was co-founded by one Michael Scanlon, who abandoned his PhD in neuroscience at Stanford to convert his research into a fledgling business. Lumosity had launched in 2005, it has grown 150% year-on-year and as of April 2013 it has 40 million members. Lumosity's iOS app has been downloaded more than 10 million times with the app frequently finding it's way to the top positions in its category. The science behind Lumosity is what they call 'neuroplasticity', which is defined as the brain's ability to physically reshape itself when faced with new, challenging problems. Lumosity also carries out research by collaborating with researchers from prestigious universities across the world, which it calls the Human Cognition Project.

Lumosity's website and app allow these researchers to conduct experiments over the Internet obviating the need to recruit participants and arranging lab visits. I took my initial Cambridge Brain Sciences test on 25th of May, it turned out that I wasn't as intelligent as I thought.

I was in the 34th percentile for short-term memory, 71st percentile for reasoning ability and the 46th percentile for verbal intelligence. My regime was to train with Lumosity in the morning after or accompanied by my morning cuppa everyday for one month. I would take the Cambridge Brain Science IQ challenge once again at the end of the month to see if I've actually made progress or not. Another thing to add here is that I used the free version of the program, which according to Lumosity was not giving me the benefit of a comprehensive training program. The paid subscription service would have given me personalized training, access to all the games that Lumosity has to offer, anytime and compare my scores with others. A monthly subscription costs \$14.95 per month, which according to the current exchange would convert to ₹887 per month. The

charge comes down to \$6.7, which is equivalent to ₹397 per month if you commit for a year or \$4.99 that is about ₹295 per month if you commit for two years. There is an option to purchase the subscription for a lifetime that costs \$299.95 that comes to around ₹17,779.

The app's interface is incredibly simple and dead easy to follow,



Lumosity